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A STUDY ON THE INFRASTRUCTURE AND EDUCATIONAL FACILITIES OF SCHOOLS IN WEST BENGAL

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ABSTRACT

The study explores West Bengal's educational institutions, facilities, curriculum, teaching personnel, and government initiatives. It highlights the importance of education in promoting progress, enhancing quality of life, and providing social benefits. Education access depends on existing infrastructure, including physical and intellectual facilities. The study aims to review the literature on schools' infrastructure and describe the status of educational facilities in West Bengal. Method of the study used a qualitative descriptive method, utilising library research and literature reviews. It identified 32 articles on the status of educational facilities and infrastructure, screening twenty papers, and evaluating their influence on learning outcomes.

The review of articles reveals that few educational institutions maintain quality infrastructure, while in the Medinipur district of West Bengal, there is a lack of quality infrastructure, teachers, and non-teaching staff. In the Darjeeling district, education is delayed due to issues like lack of libraries, limited facilities, poor road connectivity, and insufficient transportation. Quality education is crucial for nation-building and ensuring the availability and quality of educational infrastructure is essential. Research shows that some institutions maintain quality infrastructure and implementation, while others lack it. Efficient management is crucial for academic quality, as seen at Nusantara Vocational School in Balikpapan. School facilities, including classrooms, labs, dormitories, administrative amenities, and athletic facilities, play a significant role in ensuring quality education. Infrastructure influences learners' educational achievements, accounting for 16% of primary school pupils' academic success. The design of school facilities influences learning processes based on natural, exciting characteristics. School facilities' design significantly influences learning processes by being natural, stimulating, and individualized, providing an optimal atmosphere for academic performance and influencing student learning.

Keywords: Infrastructure, Education Facilities, School Education, West Bengal.

I. INTRODUCTION

Education fosters resilience, creativity, intelligence, innovation, responsibility, and mastery of science and technology. Improving education quality involves addressing several factors. The administration of school buildings has an impact on educational quality. Understanding the administrative elements of educational facilities is crucial for all educators and institutions.

Formal education. In West Bengal, the landscape of educational institutions reflects a diverse array of infrastructural and academic provisions. From the bustling urban centres to the serene rural landscapes, schools across the state endeavour to provide students with an environment conducive to learning and growth. This introduction aims to shed light on the infrastructure and educational facilities prevalent in schools throughout West Bengal, highlighting the common features and the nuanced distinctions that shape the academic experience in this region. By examining the infrastructure, curriculum, teaching staff, government initiatives, and challenges faced, we gain insight into the educational landscape that serves as the foundation for the future of West Bengal's youth. Education is essential for overall growth and enhances quality of life. Education has several societal advantages, including increased productivity, creativity, technical advancements, and entrepreneurship, which contribute to economic and social growth and improved wealth distribution. Education has a crucial role in a country's progress and wealth and the development of its social sector. It benefits society by promoting social development, and literacy, and empowering individuals to make use of available resources and economic possibilities. Education is crucial for economic and national growth, not

merely as a service. Education has numerous benefits, including economic and social returns, increased income distribution, reduced fertility, improved health outcomes, political and economic development, positive externalities, and improved quality of life. The fundamental reasons for providing free and obligatory elementary education are acknowledged in both international and national arenas.

It is argued that increased access and enrolment do not necessarily imply improved school performance or educational advancement. They are, of course, criteria of educational progress rather than measurements of educational quality (Sujatha and Geetha Rani, 2011, p. 14). People's access to education is heavily reliant on the educational infrastructure in existence. The provision of physical and intellectual infrastructure is essential for schools to function effectively and fruitfully. In terms of excellent education, a school's facilities may be classified into two categories: physical and auxiliary. Physical facilities are separated into infrastructural and educational facilities. Physical infrastructure facilities include the existence of permanent structures, boundary walls, enough space for classes, and so on. Academic facilities include a library, a laboratory, teaching and learning materials, and other amenities. Furthermore, a favourable teacher-pupil, student-classroom, teacher-per-institution, students-per-institution, co-curricular activities, teacher training and educational quality, a sufficient number of subject instructors, and so on are required to create a positive educational atmosphere within the school setting.

The Indian government has committed to providing free and compulsory education to children up to 14 years old within 10 years. This directive has been reiterated in various policies and legislation. The 93rd Amendment of the Constitution made elementary education a fundamental right, underlining the importance of universal elementary education. One of the biggest issues facing many educational institutions throughout the world is the lack of physical infrastructure in schools. Research suggests that a school's learning environment has a significant impact on academic performance and enrolment ratios. Educational institutions require amenities such as a girl's bathroom, library, boundary wall, computer, playground, classrooms, offices, and other building structures to promote successful learning. a urinal, a separate toilet for ladies, a counselling and advice centre, and so on. These amenities are also known as student welfare facilities. The current study attempts to explore and analyse indicators of education infrastructure and education status in West Bengal states. Furthermore, the relationship between them is investigated to determine the influence of education infrastructure on educational standing.

II. OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

Objectives of this present study are-

1. To review the literature related to schools' infrastructure and educational facilities.
2. To describe the Status of Educational Infrastructure and facilities available in West Bengal.

III. METHODOLOGY

The investigation took a qualitative descriptive method. This study relies on library research or literature reviews to get information on a certain topic. Researchers limited the number of articles published. This study incorporates publications from Search Scholar and Research Gate, including identification, screening, eligibility, and inclusion. During the identification process, researchers found 32 articles containing the term "Status of educational facilities and infrastructure". After passing the screening stage, evaluate the variables. This study included twenty papers judged appropriate for evaluation. The researchers examined publications under "Management and Status of Educational Facilities and Infrastructure" and assessed their influence on learning outcomes.

IV. REVIEW WITH DISCUSSION

The above shows the results of an article search with the keywords Status of educational facilities and infrastructure, which were accredited by many articles were found to be highly relevant to the study of managing educational facilities and infrastructure as an important aspect of learning. A study by **Yuniarti, Annur, and Zainnuri,. 2023**researched the administration of educational facilities and infrastructure in schools, focusing on resource acquisition, efficient usage, and preparedness. They identified management as the use of resources for specific goals, including planning, procurement, inventory, storage, maintenance, and disposal. The study explores management, which involves resource allocation, planning, and monitoring, while

educational facilities and infrastructure are separate concepts, encompassing processes like procurement, inventory, storage, maintenance, usage, and disposal. Other than explored by **Pavan Kumar and P. K. Joshi**.In August 2017, research was done on infrastructure provision at Uttarakhand's Government Degree Colleges, which included 30 colleges under the RUSA Scheme. The study sought to evaluate the overall state of these institutions, including basic infrastructural amenities, physical facility availability, recruiting percentages of teaching and non-teaching personnel, and student impressions. The research collected data from various sources, including college official documents, students, professors, and staff. According to the statistics, only 85.7% of these institutions own their property, with 19% having permanent structures and 19% operating in temporary buildings.

Pushkarna 2017 study on education facilities in Punjab analysed literacy rates and school numbers. Despite government efforts, literacy rates showed modest improvement, recommending strengthening literacy for universal education. **Duary's 2012** study in West Bengal found a lack of equality in infrastructure allocation in the Paschim Medinipur district, affecting accessibility, classroom style, and primary instruction. The research, conducted in India, did not cover school infrastructure investment money. **Yangmbi's 2019**, study explores the impact of school infrastructure on students' academic performance in Ngaliéma commune, revealing that teachers' high approval ratings highlight the importance of the school environment and infrastructure for educators' goals and suggests that school administration authorities should understand this. In their essay. The study by **Mahiwal and Kumar 2017** found that secondary school teachers in Jammu faced difficulties in implementing Rashtriya Madhyamik Shiksha Abhiyan due to delays in funding, insufficient teacher training, lack of counsel, non-teaching, insufficient funds, and inconvenient scheduling. Siliguri, West Bengal, hosted the sixteenth annual West Bengal Library Association Conference on Library and Information Science in 1976. The primary topic was the enlargement of the library. Several recommendations for school libraries were made. To improve reading habits, teenagers should be encouraged to research various subjects, which should be published in notebooks with an index, bibliography, and so on; the library should have diverse collections based on the students' ages and imaginations; a list of textbooks on various teaching subjects should be kept in the library; and proper furniture should be available **Rawat, S., and Chettri, A. 2015**Rural Darjeeling education is delayed, with challenges such as a lack of libraries, limited facilities, poor road connectivity, dorms, low teacher salaries, and insufficient transportation. The report underlines the issues that Darjeeling's rural communities confront, such as limited infrastructure, low teacher compensation, and inadequate transportation, and argues that increasing parental involvement and government assistance might enhance education. **Herdina 2019** explores facility and infrastructure administration in vocational high schools, emphasising planning, procurement, maintenance, inventory, and elimination. The study used a descriptive technique to examine symptom interpretations using observation, interviews, and recording. According to the report, effective and efficient administration of educational facilities and infrastructure is critical for ensuring academic quality. The research emphasises the significance of this management at the Nusantara Vocational School in Balikpapan.

Asiyai 2012. The research examined school infrastructure in public secondary schools in Delta State, Nigeria, concentrating on their condition, upkeep, causes contributing to depreciation, and the activities of school administrators. 640 respondents from 358 schools were surveyed using an ex-post facto research approach. The findings revealed that facilities were typically in disrepair, with minimal upkeep. Excessive facility pressure and delayed repair were among the factors that contributed to depreciation. Periodic inspections and decentralized maintenance were among the responsibilities of school administrators. The report suggested developing a strong maintenance culture, planning for facility upkeep, and providing more cash to effective school administration and maintenance.

V. RESULT AND INTERPRETATION

Based on the review of many articles the interpretation and results are presented below.

Status of educational and quality infrastructural facilities and their implementation, maintenance, and accessibility in institutions across India including West Bengal. No.1 Few educational institutions maintain quality Infrastructure and manage proper way and implementation infrastructure needs as per Institution.No.2 In the Medinipur district of West Bengal status of implementation based on infrastructural and educational

facilities now status lack of quality infrastructure, lack of teachers and non-teaching staff, and other facilities cannot be maintained as per institution and students.No.3 In the Darjeeling district of West Bengal Rural Darjeeling education is delayed, with challenges such as a lack of libraries, limited facilities, poor road connectivity, dorms, low teacher salaries, and insufficient transportation.

VI. CONCLUSION

Education is more important in nation-building and quality education provides a responsible duty of the nation and then possible to give a quality education when having an infrastructure. In this situation maintenance of the educational institution's infrastructural facilities and their availability and status. After many reviews of this article analysis and discussion are based on the status of the infrastructure, implementation, uses, and availability in the school for the students. Percentage of review results Researchers find out that some institutions maintain the availability of quality infrastructure and implementation and maintain quality education, and some education institutions do have not enough quality or educational infrastructure and availability of infrastructure. Herdina's article discusses facility and infrastructure administration in vocational high schools, highlighting the importance of efficient management for academic quality, particularly at Nusantara Vocational School in Balikpapan. In this way, many researchers have highlighted the basis of educational facilities, educational availability, management and use in their articles. It is said that depending on their result the learning environment in schools significantly influences academic performance and enrolment. Facilities like restrooms, libraries, and student welfare centres promote successful learning and student welfare. According to various research on school facilities, we must define school facilities as buildings that house classrooms, labs, dormitories, administration, administrative amenities, athletic facilities, or other facilities managed in conjunction with a school. They play a significant role in guaranteeing quality education. This is one of the criteria used to assess educational growth and development. Recent studies done in the United Kingdom have revealed that infrastructure influences learners' educational achievements, accounting for 16% of the difference in primary school pupils' academic success. This investigation demonstrates that the design of school facilities has an influence on learning processes based on three characteristics: they must be natural (e.g., light and air quality), exciting (e.g., colours and complexity),

This analysis demonstrates that the way school facilities are designed has an impact on learning processes based on three characteristics: they must be natural (e.g., light and air quality), stimulating (e.g., colours and complexity), and individualized (e.g., learning space flexibility).

A big school facility is more than just a structure that has been well-maintained, inspected regularly, and other precautionary measures taken. Rather, school buildings must provide anoptimal atmosphere for academic performance based on research findings that show a direct influence on student learning.

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